UNICITY PROTOCOL · STRATEGIC PROPOSAL · 2026

SECURING THE AGENTIC ECONOMY.

Proof of identity and permission, bound to the payment itself.

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PREPARED FOR
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ACT I · THE SHIFT

THE AGENTS ARE HERE. NOTHING VOUCHES FOR THEM.

They pay each other faster than anything built for people can stop to ask **who they are** — or **whether they should**.

57.5%

OF ALL WEB REQUESTS ARE NOW AUTOMATED — CLOUDFLARE, 2026

Legacy networks cannot verify an agent's authority or enforce a budget without a centralized bottleneck. Unicity binds the **proof of authority to the money** — it travels with every transaction.

ACT II · WHY THE DESIGN FAILS

A MACHINE CANNOT WAIT FOR A SHARED LEDGER.

Before one payment clears, **every node on earth** must hear it, agree where it falls in line, re-run it, and store it forever — the agent waits on a crowd of strangers reaching consensus.

Every node must **broadcast, order, validate, and record** every transaction. Machine-speed commerce requires eliminating the **shared ledger** entirely.

BROADCAST

Every node hears every transaction.

ORDER

Global agreement on the sequence of every one.

VALIDATE

Every node re-runs every one.

RECORD

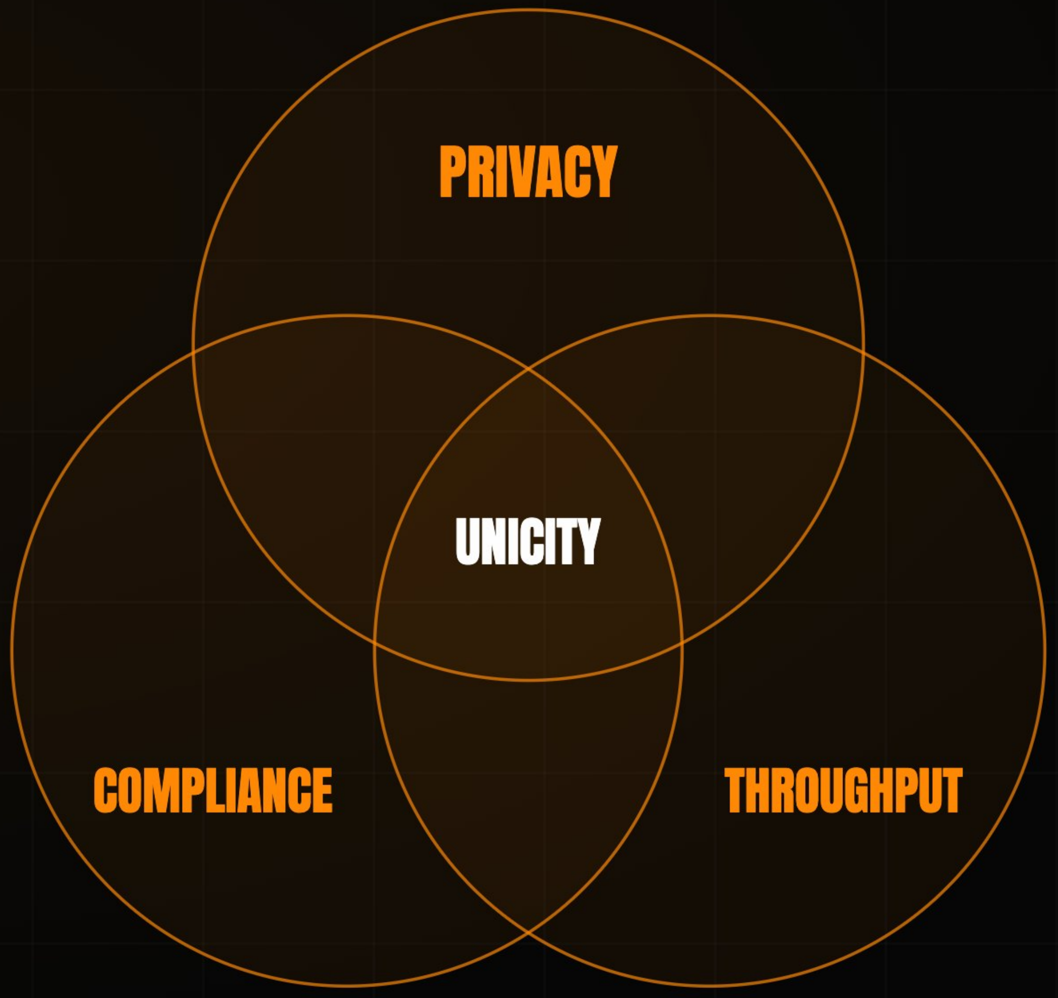
Every node stores the whole state, forever.

ACT II · WHY THE DESIGN FAILS

EVERY DIGITAL DOLLAR TRADES ONE AWAY.

Verified, private, instantly settled — move a dollar in the open and the design forces you to **surrender one of the three**.

Every design so far sacrifices one of the three, and the whole payment landscape is trapped in the trade-off. **Unicity** solves all three at once — it never places the transaction on a shared ledger to begin with.



ACT II · THE GAP

TWO ARE SOLVED. ONE NEVER WAS.

Open infrastructure removed the middleman. Stablecoins moved the value. But **proving who is on the other end** was never built.

01	**DISINTERMEDIATION** Open infrastructure bypassed the legacy financial middleman.	SOLVED
02	**DIGITAL VALUE** Stablecoins now settle tens of trillions of dollars a year.	SOLVED
03	**CRYPTOGRAPHIC IDENTITY** No open settlement layer verifies a recipient's standing inside the asset before the transfer — the check sits in a separate venue, and gets skipped.	UNSOLVED

Unicity closes it by putting identity inside the asset — where a check cannot be skipped.

ACT II · THE STAKES

THE MARKET IS SPENDING BILLIONS — AND STILL MISSING IT.

Each one optimizes the ledger, or routes around it by splitting the proof across layers. They treat the symptom; the ledger itself is the flaw.

The incumbents are spending billions to work around the ledger they built, authorizing in one layer and settling in another. **Unicity keeps authorization, settlement, and the audit trail whole, inside the asset.**

PLAYER	THEIR MOVE	APPROACH
CIRCLE	Pivoted to infrastructure — the Arc L1, a $222M presale, bought Malachite.	optimise the ledger
SOLANA	Alpenglow cut finality to ~150ms; its co-founder concedes a physical ceiling.	optimise the ledger
AP2 · X402	Authorize in one layer, settle in another — the proof splits across the stack.	split the proof
UNICITY	Keeps authorization, settlement, and the audit trail inside the asset.	keep it whole

ACT III · THE ANSWER

SO TAKE THE DOLLAR OFF THE LEDGER.

Make it carry its own proof — a digital dollar that settles like cash in hand, no ledger to ask permission.

Unicity converts an on-chain stablecoin into a **self-contained, self-proving bearer instrument**. It carries its own proof and moves **peer-to-peer** over any channel — HTTP, QR, NOSTR — with zero ledger lookups.

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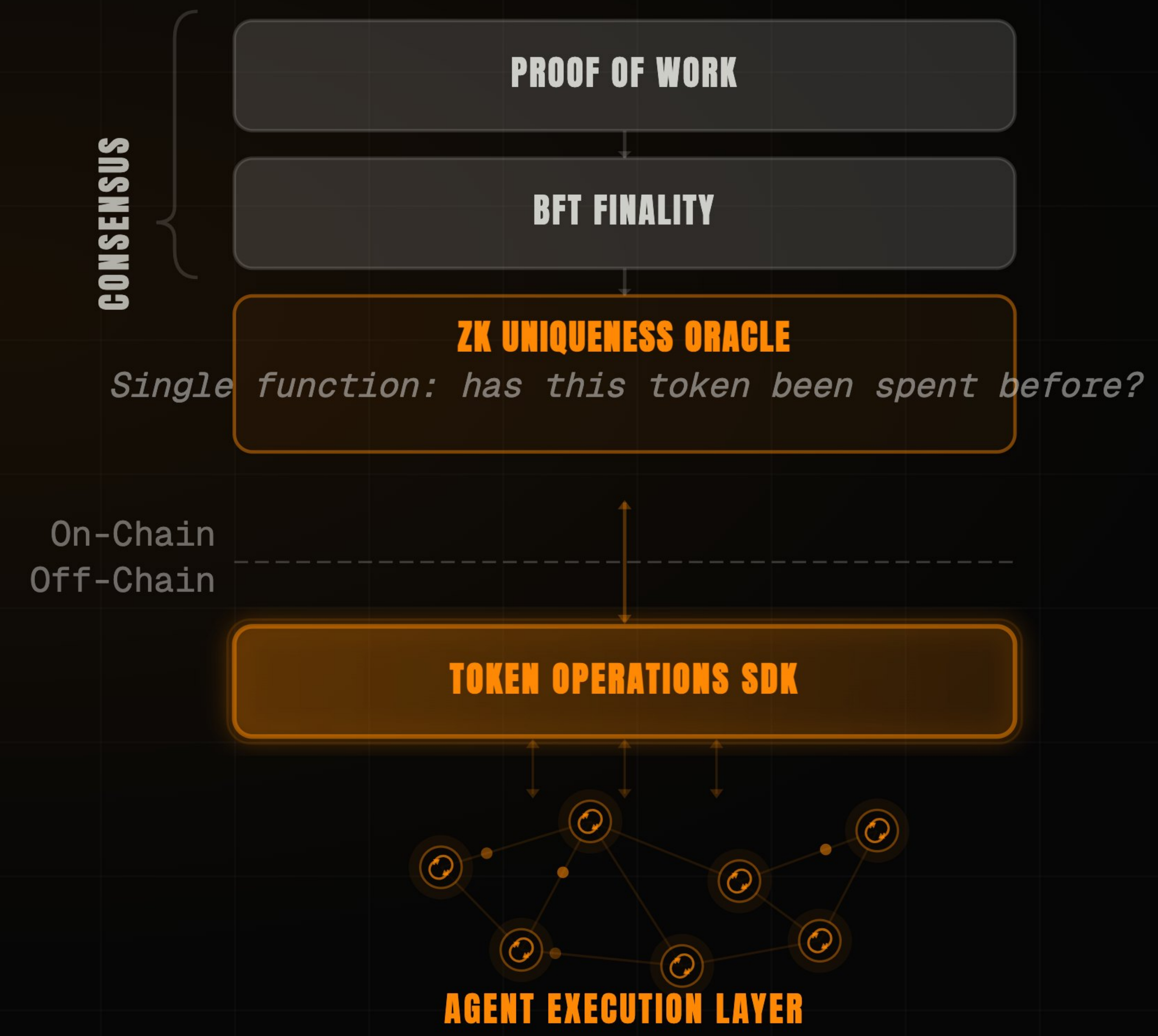
ACT III · THE ANSWER

SO THE CHAIN DOES ONE JOB.

Consensus secures the record and nothing more — nothing an agent touches waits on it.

Proof-of-work, BFT finality, and a ZK uniqueness oracle keep the chain minimal — the oracle attests one thing, whether a token has been spent, so throughput scales horizontally — **30,000 transactions per second per shard, by design**. Everything an agent touches runs off-chain. **The chain does one job — the economy runs beside it.**



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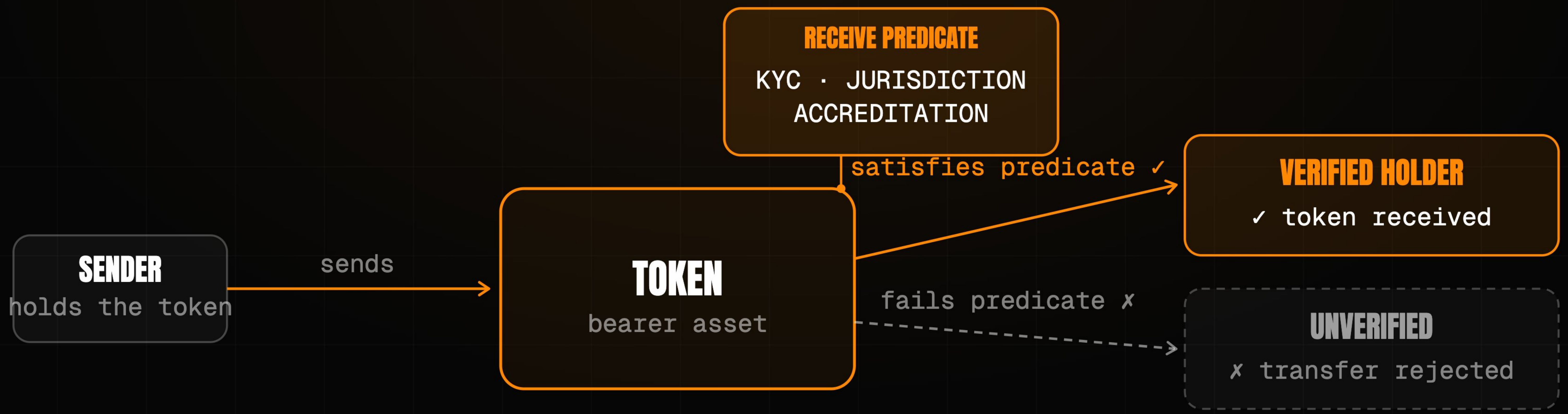
ACT III · THE ANSWER

NOW COMPLIANCE NEEDS NO MIDDLEMAN.

The asset itself asks **whether they should** — and refuses the wrong recipient, with no venue in the loop.

The **Receive Predicate** programs KYC, jurisdiction, and accreditation directly into the asset. If the recipient cannot satisfy it locally, the transfer mathematically fails — **the asset enforces its own compliance.**



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ACT III · THE ANSWER

AND THE OPEN LEDGER GOES DARK.

Three observers watch every public chain — the network, the sender, the address. None of them can see in.

Confidentiality is a founding property of the protocol, proven against all three observers — private to everyone, attestable to the one counterparty or regulator who has to be satisfied. That is the floor for institutional capital.

THE NETWORK	Sees only opaque commitments. It cannot read amounts, parties, or balances, nor link one transfer to the next.	PROVEN
THE SENDER	Cannot watch where or when the recipient later spends what was sent.	PROVEN
ANYONE WITH THE ADDRESS	Sees one published key; every sender derives a fresh, indistinguishable transaction key.	PROVEN

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ACT III · THE ANSWER

SO THEY SETTLE WITH NO CLOCK TO ATTACK.

Trustless atomic swaps between self-contained bearer assets.

The old fix is a timed lock, and the clock is the attack surface — one side stalls and walks. Unicity removes it with **Predicate Swaps**: both commit independently, and the swap forms for both **at once or not at all**. No bridge holds the value, either — a locked asset becomes a token the recipient verifies against its source, so the biggest loss in crypto has nothing left to drain.

HASHED TIMELOCK (HTLC)

1 · A locks, reveals hash y

2 · B locks against same y

3 · A claims, revealing preimage x

4 · B must claim before timeout

THE TIMING TRAP

B late on step 4 — a dropped connection — and A keeps both.

UNICITY PREDICATE SWAP

A COMMITS
locks their token

B COMMITS
locks their token

UNICITY SERVICE
the shared reference

AUTOMATIC FAIRNESS

- ✓ both locked → swap completes
- ✓ either walked away → both refunded
- ✓ no deadlines, no chasing, done

ACT III · THE ANSWER

TWELVE STEPS BECOME FIVE.

Watch the handshake collapse. **Seven steps drop out**, and the friction operators spend billions on is gone.

Today x402 still routes settlement through a facilitator and a public chain. Unicity embeds authorization and proof in the token and cuts the handshake **from twelve steps to five.**

TRADITIONAL X402	12 STEPS
1	Client requests the resource
2	Server returns 402 Payment Required
3	Client signs and submits payment
4	~~Server forwards to facilitator~~
5	~~Facilitator verifies on-chain balance~~
6	~~Settle on the shared ledger~~
7	~~Await block confirmation~~
8	~~Facilitator confirms to server~~
…	then deliver the resource

UNICITY X402	5 STEPS
1	Client requests the resource
2	Server returns 402 Payment Required
3	Client pays with a bearer token (auth + proof inside)
4	Server verifies the token locally
5	Server delivers the resource

7 STEPS ELIMINATED

No facilitator. No shared ledger. No block wait.

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ACT III · THE ANSWER

A MARKET WITH NO VENUE.

Every other column gives one up. **Read the last one straight down** — nothing does.

Legacy venues force a compromise. Unicity delivers **exchange speed, self-custody, privacy, and compliance** — with no venue at all.

	LEGACY CEX	LEGACY DEX	UNICITY
SPEED	sub-second	block time	sub-second
CUSTODY	custodial	self-custodial	self-custodial
PRIVACY	operator sees all	fully public	unlinkable
COMPLIANCE	off-chain	none	in the asset

ACT III · THE ANSWER

AND A WHOLE COMPANY RUN BY AGENTS.

No desk, no operator — the agents are the company, and the same protocol carrying the dollar carries them.

Unicity built BlackRock DAC — a reference parametric insurer, fully on-protocol, whose capital, underwriting, and cession all run as agents. Settlement is only the entry point: **the same protocol can run the whole corporation**.

THE TEAM

BUILT BY INFRASTRUCTURE VETERANS.

Unicity Labs. PhDs in machine learning and cryptography, with fifteen years building security infrastructure for **DARPA, NATO, Lockheed, Verizon, and Maersk**. Now applying that to the money your agents move.

Mike Gault

CEO

- PhD Electrical Engineering
- Built & exited Guardtime (ADX:IHC)
- Ex-MD, Barclays Capital

Tony Kenyon

CTO

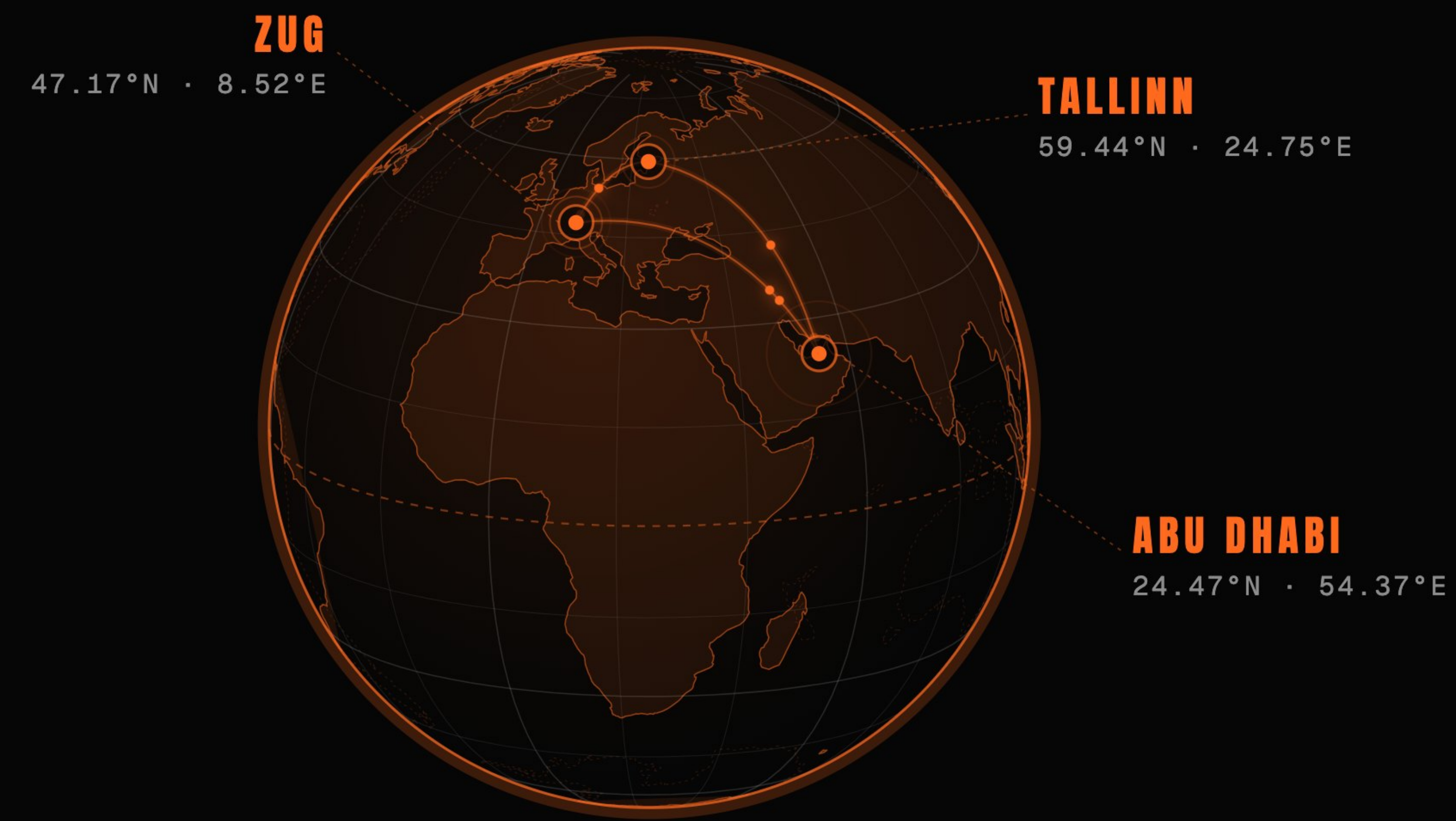
- PhD Machine Learning
- 25 years shipping enterprise AI & infra
- Principal Architect: BT, Nokia, A10

Alan Radi

COMMERCIAL

- 12 years implementing CX AI for Global B2C brands
- Apple · Google · Verizon · Pepsi · DHL

WHERE WE OPERATE



CRYPTOGRAPHIC INFRASTRUCTURE TRUSTED BY

NATO OTAN · DARPA · LOCKHEED MARTIN · verizon · BIS · MAERSK · esa European Space Agency

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ACT IV · THE NEXT STEP

SHIP THE FIRST COMPLIANT DOLLAR.

A regulated dollar that settles peer-to-peer the moment the Receive Predicate is satisfied.

Co-design the Receive Predicate with a regulated deposit issuer – the first dollar that settles the moment its counterparty clears.

The first asset where the proof of who you are — and what you may do — travels with the money itself.

Compliance has always lived in a walled garden. Put it inside the dollar, and you own the layer the agentic economy settles on.

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